

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - September 29, 2026

Compiled summary for Tuesday, September 29, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the September 28 landing workspace documentation state, verifying the United States Eastern date, running the customary project reader, extracting and studying all forty-three pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs, preserving the local Next.js preview, rebuilding the My Work Space and My Work Tools presentation around a mirrored center-divider system, refining workstation and QA-device hierarchy, separating Design Software and Coding Software treatments, expanding My Workflow from four stages into a responsive seven-stage tab progression, repositioning the landing hero profile and device composition, adapting an About Dev product quote into a responsive three-row bridge, validating desktop and compact geometry, documenting committed source state e6444f2, refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot, and generating the September 29 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, work-completed sections, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Prahl/portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_september28.pdf and after the September 28 documentation state. The source state reviewed for this record is e6444f27a6b9d3bc1e1e0080a9180400df544e6d on main, matching origin/main, titled Refined Landing Hero Profile and Messaging. The September 29 work is represented by four source commits: a875ad3, c0b0e37, c53157d, and e6444f2. Together they changed app/PortfolioSections.tsx, app/globals.css, app/page.tsx, and the committed project snapshot with a net 696 insertions and 108 deletions relative to the prior documentation commit. No Hostinger deploy-branch work, static production publish, GitHub Actions dispatch, or public deployment was performed during this record. The local documentation deltas created by this generation pass are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt file and this September 29 root-level PDF worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date through an external UTC-04:00 time check, which reported September 29, 2026 at 3:35 PM, and through TZ=America/New_York date, which reported Tuesday, September 29, 2026 at 3:36 PM EDT with UTC offset -0400. The worklog therefore uses September 29 rather than relying on the host or UTC calendar date.
- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before composing this record, preserving the convention that current source, assets, configuration, PDF inventory, Git context, and standing workflow instructions are refreshed for documentation.
- Extracted and studied all forty-three pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs with pdftotext: fifteen July records, fifteen August records, and thirteen September records through portfolio_worklog_september28.pdf. The series contained 251 PDF pages and approximately 118,383 extracted words before this artifact.
- Compared the complete record set for filename cadence, same-day Part suffix behavior, title construction, opening-summary density, source and baseline framing, bullet-heavy technical voice, validation language, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, dated footers, and output-artifact closure.
- Used the September 28 record as the closest chronological and structural baseline, September 21 for the original About Dev quote and workflow narrative, September 15 for the profile-bubble history, and the August 1 Part 3 record for the earlier landing hero visual-centering behavior.
- Checked pdfinfo and pdf fonts across the mature series. The established artifact remains US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold Type 1 fonts, no encryption, Codex metadata, dense black-on-white technical copy, and a repeated dated page footer.
- Reviewed commits a875ad3, c0b0e37, c53157d, and e6444f2 through git log, git show, git diff, commit bodies, file statistics, branch tracking, and the refreshed project snapshot. Confirmed main and origin/main resolve to the same final commit.
- Reviewed app/page.tsx, app/globals.css, app/PortfolioSections.tsx, the current local landing route, the About Dev source quote, and the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt as the source and documentation files carrying the September 29 work.

Baseline Status Before September 29 Work

- The September 28 state had introduced My Workspace, My Work Tools, the shared workflow, and Core Beliefs on the landing page, but the workspace still read as a conventional left-to-right two-column list rather than the requested alternating composition around a center divider.
- Workstation, QA Devices, and Software used the first-pass label, icon, header, and nested-list geometry. Their mirrored alignment, divider breathing room, icon side, and nested indentation still needed extensive wide-screen and compact refinement.
- The workflow retained four content stages with numbers embedded in the banner treatment. It did not yet provide separate number tabs, named tabs, the requested horizontal progression, mirrored return path, or placeholder Testing, Building, and Release stages.

- The landing hero profile photo and nametag remained positioned inside the visual stack. At wide ratios the identity stack was not tied responsively to the three-line green eyebrow copy, while the device composition needed a modest upward adjustment without changing screenshot or frame internals.
- The About Dev product quote was not present on the landing hero. The accepted new treatment needed responsive wide and compact placement, deliberately large type, three equal-width rows, and a vertical relationship locked to the profile photo even while viewport dimensions changed.

Goals for September 29

- Rebuild My Work Space and My Work Tools as an alternating center-divider composition with intentional icon, eyebrow, white-header, and muted-detail alignment on both sides.
- Preserve the established workstation and software information while clarifying WORK STATION, QA DEVICES, DESIGN SOFTWARE, and CODING SOFTWARE as distinct visual groups.
- Unify phone and tablet taxonomy under Smartphones / Tablets for Android and iOS, retain a paragraph break between phone and tablet names, and keep nested detail edges aligned with their parent headers.
- Expand My Workflow into seven numbered banners with separate number and name tabs, symmetric progression, responsive typography, and compact layouts that remain readable without collapsing immediately to the smallest type size.
- Move the wide hero identity stack into a responsive relationship with the green eyebrow copy, bring the device composition closer without changing frame internals, and preserve the existing compact profile behavior.
- Add the revised product quote between the hero copy and profile, keep its word order in three balanced rows, align it vertically with the photo circle during resizing, and allow intentional clipping where the enlarged type exceeds its lane.
- Validate TypeScript, local routes, browser geometry around the 980/981px breakpoint, current Git state, and documentation conventions before generating the dated PDF.

Work Completed - Workspace Divider, Headings, and Stack Rhythm

- Rebuilt the workspace presentation around the central vertical divider and repeatedly swapped the left and right stack placement until the final alternating order matched the requested visual rhythm.
- Renamed My Workspace to My Work Space and increased both My Work Space and My Work Tools title scales by fifty percent. Centered the two large white headings across the divider in their own vertical zones while suppressing the divider through those title zones.
- Removed the HOW I'M SET UP and WHERE I WORK eyebrows, leaving the large titles to carry the section transition without redundant green kickers. Made the shared SectionHeading kicker optional so a missing kicker does not leave empty markup.
- Changed WORKSTATION to the two-line WORK / STATION treatment and SOFTWARE to DESIGN / SOFTWARE, then added CODING / SOFTWARE as a second two-line green eyebrow for the lower software group.
- Scaled the three primary icons to the perceived height of the two-line eyebrows, increased the workstation icon by a final five percent, and aligned each icon, eyebrow, white header, and muted word stack on a consistent horizontal plane.
- Moved the monitor, phone, palette, and braces symbols across the divider through the requested iterations, then settled WORK STATION back into icon-left/content-right while QA DEVICES remained mirrored with its icon on the right.
- Expanded isolated divider-only runs and the short divider segments adjacent to the icon/eyebrow rows, producing more text-related breathing room without changing the content itself.
- Matched the right-side stack headers to their green eyebrow left edges, matched gray nested rows to their white parent-header edges, and preserved the established internal indent hierarchy while changing outer alignment.

Work Completed - Devices and Software Taxonomy

- Kept the WORK STATION content limited to Laptop and External Monitor, matched the External Monitor header to the Laptop font size, and pulled the complete stack upward so its two-line eyebrow shares the icon's vertical plane.
- Mirrored QA DEVICES to the opposite side of the divider, placed its phone icon on the outer side, and retained Android and iOS as the primary white platform headers.
- Consolidated the earlier separate Smartphones and Tablets headers under both platforms into one Smartphones / Tablets header, kept every relevant device in a continuous list, and inserted a deliberate paragraph break before Galaxy Tab A and iPad Air 14.
- Swapped the DESIGN SOFTWARE and CODING SOFTWARE horizontal alignment properties so the palette-led design group and braces-led coding group alternate around the divider rather than repeating the same orientation.

- Moved the palette icon to the DESIGN SOFTWARE eyebrow and the braces icon to CODING SOFTWARE. Kept Development Environments, AI-Assisted Development, and Design & Motion together above Testing & Debugging and Workflow Platforms.
- Preserved the curated tool inventory from September 28 while changing only presentation and grouping. No application names were removed during the final September 29 alignment pass.
- Added wide and compact responsive resets for mirrored text alignment, icon placement, nested-list indentation, and divider behavior so desktop asymmetry does not leak into stacked phone layouts.

Work Completed - Seven-Stage My Workflow Tabs

- Moved My Workflow ahead of My Core Beliefs and converted each workflow heading into a raised name tab above its banner, with the two-digit index occupying a separate adjacent tab.
- Renamed the original four tab labels to Research, Plan, Scaffold, and Analyze while preserving the underlying Industry & Product Research, Project Planning, Scaffolding the Workflow, and Learning-As-I-Go body copy.
- Added three placeholder stages - 05 Testing, 06 Building, and 07 Release - to extend the workflow from discovery through release and create a seven-stage visual narrative ready for later content.
- Reduced number-tab width from twenty percent to ten percent on wide layouts while leaving name tabs at twenty percent, and kept every number tab immediately to the left of its related name tab.
- Distributed 01 Research and 07 Release flush to the left and built the intermediate progression through 02 Plan, 03 Scaffold, 04 Analyze, 05 Testing, and 06 Building as a forward-and-return horizontal sequence.
- Linked index and name typography to the same custom font-size variable so 01 through 07 always resize with their named tabs instead of drifting into a second scale.
- Doubled number and name tab widths on compact portrait layouts, permitted deliberate horizontal overlap between neighboring tab tracks, and used fluid type that shrinks through intermediate readable sizes before reaching the smallest compact value.

Work Completed - Landing Hero Profile, Devices, and Quote

- Extracted the profile photo, About Dev link, and Martin Prahll nametag into a reusable ProfileOrbit component, then rendered mutually exclusive wide and compact instances so each layout can position the same identity asset without duplicating content logic.
- Placed the wide profile stack as an absolute hero-grid layer, preserved the compact instance inside the visual composition, and used the 981px breakpoint to ensure exactly one profile instance is visible at a time.
- Lowered the wide profile enough to clear the navigation and its glow, then lifted the device composition by thirty pixels. Follow-up five-pixel adjustments brought the two groups closer while keeping substantially more breathing room than the original arrangement.
- Did not change the internal placement, crop, screenshot content, or relative geometry of the phone and tablet frames. The hero-visual group moved as one unit through its existing center-offset variable.
- Adapted the About Dev idea-to-product quote for the landing hero, removed world-changing from the final copy, and finalized the text as: Everyone's got a brilliant idea. Few know how to funnel it into a must-have product.
- Changed the quote from two lines to three and repartitioned it as Everyone's got a brilliant / idea. Few know how to funnel / it into a must-have product. Applied small horizontal scale corrections to the first and third rows so all three rendered widths match visually.
- Increased the quote twice, retained the latest large responsive font clamps, and explicitly allowed overflow, overlap, and clipping when narrow lanes cannot contain the enlarged text.
- Anchored the wide quote between the green hero eyebrow and profile, placed the compact quote to the left of the compact photo lane, and tied both quote centers to the profile-photo circle rather than the nametag or full orbit box.
- Used separate wide and compact photo anchor names so the quote remains vertically centered before, during, and after resizing, including the transition between the 980px stacked layout and 981px two-column layout.

Work Completed - Cache Handling and Documentation Context

- Detected repeated Turbopack states where new JSX loaded before the matching stylesheet. Stopped the local server, moved generated .next directories to recoverable temporary paths, restarted Next.js, and re-measured only after the served CSS matched source.
- Kept the local preview running at http://127.0.0.1:3000 and used the installed Google Chrome through Playwright for responsive geometry checks rather than relying only on source inspection.
- Recommended past-tense commit messages during the work sequence, then reviewed the resulting four committed records and their bodies for this consolidated worklog.
- Ran the customary project reader again during worklog generation so the snapshot now records the final e6444f2 source state and the current worklog inventory before this PDF is added.

Committed Source Sequence

- Commit a875ad3, Refined the landing workspace and work tools presentation, established the main structural direction. It rebuilt the two workspace columns around the divider, enlarged and centered My Work Space and My Work Tools, added distinct Design Software and Coding Software treatments, reordered My Workflow ahead of My Core Beliefs, made section kickers optional, and refreshed the project snapshot. Its 360 insertions and 68 deletions across four files represent the largest September 29 source pass.
- Commit c0b0e37, Expanded the My Workflow timeline into a responsive seven-stage tab system, separated number tabs from name tabs, added the three placeholder stages, and encoded the forward-and-reverse progression. It also introduced compact overlap behavior and synchronized fluid typography so index and name remain one responsive unit. That pass added 146 lines and removed 11 across app/page.tsx and app/globals.css.
- Commit c53157d, Refined the workspace stack alignment and device presentation, captured the final workspace corrections after visual review. It mirrored QA Devices, restored Work Station to the opposite orientation, swapped Design Software and Coding Software alignment, merged phone and tablet headings, and added the requested paragraph separation before tablet names. The pass added 61 lines and removed 26 without changing unrelated routes or project-page content.
- Commit e6444f2, Refined Landing Hero Profile and Messaging, finalized the current source state. It introduced reusable profile and quote components, mutually exclusive wide and compact variants, the responsive anchor system, the three equalized quote rows, and the device-group vertical offset. The pass added 143 lines and removed 17 across the landing page and global stylesheet while preserving the internal device screenshots and frame geometry.
- The four commits form one ordered presentation pass rather than unrelated features: workspace structure came first, workflow navigation expanded second, device and software hierarchy was corrected third, and the landing hero identity/messaging composition closed the session. This record preserves that sequence so later diffs can be interpreted against the exact design decisions that preceded them.

Validation Summary

- npm run check passed after the final hero quote and anchor work with tsc --noEmit, and git diff --check reported no application-source whitespace errors.
- Confirmed the local landing route and /aboutdev each returned HTTP 200 from the running Next.js 16.2.10 Turbopack server during the documentation pass.
- Browser checks covered 320, 390, 720, 979, 980, 981, 1100, 1440, and 1920 pixel widths. Exactly one quote/profile variant was visible at each width, and compact-to-wide switching occurred at the intended breakpoint.
- Measured quote-center versus profile-photo-center deltas at 0.00px through compact widths and 0.01px through wide widths, confirming stable vertical centering before, during, and after responsive resizing.
- Measured the three equalized quote rows at approximately 379.0px, 379.2px, and 379.3px at the 1440px reference width, with proportional equality preserved by the same scale factors at smaller viewports.
- Confirmed the quote remains absolutely positioned with visible overflow, so it does not enter grid flow or move the profile, green eyebrow copy, navigation, or device frames even when intentional clipping occurs.
- Confirmed the four September 29 commits produce a net 696 insertions and 108 deletions across four tracked files relative to the September 28 PDF commit, and main matches origin/main at e6444f2.
- After the customary project-reader pass, portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt is the only tracked pre-PDF documentation delta. No static export, production deployment, or public-site verification was performed for this local record.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/page.tsx - reorganized workspace data and device groups, added Design/Coding Software presentation hooks, expanded the workflow to seven stages, introduced reusable profile and quote components, and carried the final three-line quote copy.
- app/globals.css - implemented mirrored divider geometry, icon and nested-text alignment, responsive workspace resets, workflow number/name tabs, hero profile variants, quote row equalization, anchor positioning, and the device-group center offset.
- app/PortfolioSections.tsx - made SectionHeading kicker optional so the landing workspace and tools headings can render without redundant eyebrow text.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed through ./read_project.sh so the documentation companion records final source state e6444f2, current assets, all prior PDF worklogs, and Git context.
- portfolio_worklog_september29.pdf - generated as this new root-level dated Portfolio documentation artifact.

Follow-Up Context

- Testing, Building, and Release are intentionally placeholder workflow banners. Future content should preserve the seven-tab progression and replace the blank bodies without collapsing the established tab tracks.
- Workspace alignment is deliberately asymmetric on wide screens and normalized on compact screens. Future content edits should preserve the outer mirror behavior and the current nested-header indentation separately.
- The quote's first and third rows use horizontal scale corrections to match the middle row's rendered width. Wording or font changes should trigger a fresh three-row width measurement rather than retaining those ratios blindly.
- Wide and compact quote placement depends on CSS anchor positioning tied to the respective photo links. Keep the photo anchor names and mutually exclusive profile variants together when refactoring the hero.
- The hero device screenshots and frame internals were intentionally protected during the profile and quote work. Future hero spacing changes should continue to move the existing hero-visual wrapper as one group unless the user explicitly requests internal frame edits.
- As with prior Portfolio work, ask for the commit message before committing or pushing the refreshed snapshot or this PDF unless the user explicitly supplies the message and requests the operation.

Output Artifact

- Created /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_september29.pdf.
- Used the established filename because this is the first Portfolio worklog for September 29, 2026; no Part suffix was needed.
- Produced a US Letter, PDF 1.4, unencrypted document using Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold with Codex title, subject, author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Preserved the established dense technical narrative, section ordering, repeated dated page footer, and end-of-document continuity notes used by the recent Portfolio worklog series.
- Source state reviewed: e6444f27a6b9d3bc1e1e0080a9180400df544e6d on main and origin/main.
- No source commit, push, deployment, Hostinger synchronization, or production publish was performed as part of generating this PDF artifact.